

pain, flu and even pimples. The taps on drinking water dispensers are among the most commonly touched surfaces.

Nowadays, there is an inclination towards touchless technologies, both locally and globally, because monitoring and enforcing a hand-washing culture is very difficult both in developing and developed nations. You may not know what infections other people are carrying. Most people do not wash their hands after coughing, using toilets, handling cash, using ATMs and so on. As a result, washrooms are now being equipped with touchless faucets, soap dispensers and hand dryers. Some airports, western hospitals and universities also have touchless drinking water fountains and bottle filling stations.

MoPure from Realment Labs helps to reduce spread of infections in common establishments by dispensing drinking water through a tap when the user places a hand over the sensor. It is food-grade and tested by a water-quality lab. You might have used similar systems in some washrooms. However, MoPure is different!



MoPure in action

Existing touchless systems have limitations when used with drinking water at low pressure and in portable systems. MoPure overcomes these limitations. It is cheaper, safer, convenient and highly compatible with the most commonly used drinking water dispensers globally. It also provides convenience in households, especially while cooking and handling uncooked food.

The MoPure touchless dispenser package includes a storage container

(capable of holding a 20-25 litre water can), integrated touchless tap unit (removable for cleaning) and a 5V, 2A DC power supply adaptor. It uses proprietary mechanisms to control the flow of drinking water externally using a microcontroller and electromagnetic actuators.

Challenges

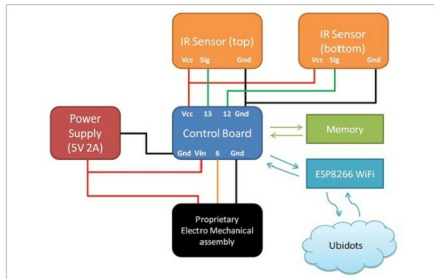
Negotiating with investors to retain maximum control over the company was a highly time-consuming process. On top of that, closing deals with organisations and corporates is a long bureaucratic process in some cases. Organisational clients take time to trust startup products and delay their payments.

Future challenges in retail might even include fight over shelf space. Consumer goods startups would require the financial muscle to get into that segment.

The innovation has been recognised by DIPP Startup India and Karnataka Biotechnology and Information Technology Services (KBITS). It is supported by DERBI Foundation, an incubator affiliated to The Department of Science & Technology (DST). MoPure was among the top ten finalists in Headstart Kickstart contest held in May 2017 in South India.

The company has exhibited bare version of MoPure in big trade shows such as *India Manufacturing Show* and *Invest in Karnataka*. They have received over a thousand pre-production inquiries from distributors, offices, factory owners, gyms, schools and individuals and are currently closing orders for their market version.

Realment wants to create a culture of improved sanitation in the drinking water ecosystem and educate the public about touchless solutions. To deliver a social impact, they are looking to collaborate with organisations and individuals who would like to contribute to the implementation of this touchless healthcare solution in various parts of India in government schools, hospitals, offices and rural establishments. **EFY**



Architecture using Arduino Pro Mini as control board